



▲ THE ZINC-CLAD EXTERIOR OF THE JEWISH MUSEUM

Jewish Museum

Location Berlin, Germany

Berlin's first Jewish Museum opened 6 days before Hitler came to power in 1933. Unsurprisingly, its end was sudden and absolute. In 1988, the city's government announced plans to build a new museum, which opened in 2001. The museum consists of two startlingly different buildings. The first, which is Baroque in style, was originally the Berlin Museum. The other, accessible only from the first, is a disconcerting and powerful new building with a fractured and tormented zinc exterior. Designed by Polish American architect Daniel

Libeskind, the building is laid out in a snakelike zigzag pattern, and the interior is slashed through with what the architect called "voids"—narrow, disjointed, alienating corridors representing the continuity of Jewish life in Germany. These corridors lead progressively to the Garden of Exile, its sloping floor disconcertingly studded with towers, and the Holocaust Tower, an empty, echoing silo with no exhibits.

Tate Modern

Location London, England

Tate Modern is housed in what was formerly the Bankside Power Station, on the South Bank of the River Thames. Designed by British architect

Giles Gilbert Scott and built in stages from 1947, it eventually closed in 1981. In 2000, triumphantly recast by Swiss architects Jacques Herzog and Pierre de Meuron, it reopened as an art gallery. It was an instant success, in part because the original building was so powerfully molded, but also because its new architects recognized that this industrial muscularity would act as the perfect foil for the museum's collection of 20th-century art. For example, what was once the Turbine Hall was reinvented as a vast display space. A further phase of redevelopment followed, culminating in 2016 with the opening of Herzog and de Meuron's Switch House, a dramatically contorted brick tower.

30 St. Mary Axe

Location London, England

There is no more instantly recognizable building in London than British architect Norman Foster's 30 St. Mary Axe, known informally as the Gherkin. Built in 2001, this gleaming, bulletlike structure, rising 590 ft (180 m), is criss-crossed by its strongly banded diagonal steel grid. If it belongs to no obvious architectural manner other than the startlingly new, it is nevertheless a supremely rational building. It has been praised for its energy efficiency, with a natural ventilation system acting between twin outer layers of glass to warm the building in winter and cool it in summer. It has a sophisticated computer-controlled system that opens windows automatically if